the district on the morning of 16 December 2022. While I could have participated in the Dalit Samvad on other occasions, I chose the ‘Walk and Talk’ slot. Instead of sitting and conversing with a contemporary karmayogi such as Rahul Gandhi, I wanted to engage in a conversation while walking, so I could also contribute some steps in this journey to unite India.

As decided, we had to reach the base camp set up in the Meena Panchayat complex in Nangal Rajawatan very early in the morning. Ganesh, the son of a female Dalit activist, Mohini Bai, reached my Jaipur residence at 3 a.m. with his car. I was ready, so we left without any delay. We reached the house of the famous journalist Om Thanvi ji, former vice chancellor of the Haridev Joshi Journalism University. He was also ready, so we took the Dausa route. I kept talking to Thanvi ji throughout. Before 5 o’clock we had reached a place called Meena High Court. The police security and the light coming from the camp showed that we had reached the destination.

In the base camp, I met many acquaintances, such as Yogendra Yadav, Shankar Singh, Nikhil Dey, Mukesh Nirvasit and my younger son Lalit Meghwanshi, who is studying journalism and was accompanying this journey from Jhalawar as a yatri from Rajasthan. The view of the camp was amazing. It was not even 5 a.m. and people had already woken up and were getting ready. Sleeping mattresses were put inside a huge tent, and tea and breakfast had started. The yatris were standing in a queue in a very disciplined manner, waiting for their turn. Those who raise questions about the Congress cadre should have seen the discipline and the spirit of the Bharat yatris, the Rajasthan yatris and the atithi yatris. Those who have even the slightest belief in the false propaganda of the BJP of a ‘Congress-mukt Bharat’ should witness the deep-rooted presence of the Congress among the people of India. It may not be traditionally known as a cadre-based party, but the Congress is definitely not a disorganized crowd. Irrespective of whether they were Congress workers, supporters or well-wishers, there was a deep joy on their faces. Their enthusiasm, discipline and commitment to the Bharat Jodo idea offer compelling responses to the